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Christian Counseling & Services

Free guide

Closer

A guide to healthier relationships



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Welcome

Every relationship goes through hard seasons. Feeling distant, misunderstood or tired of the same arguments does not mean it is over.

Small, steady changes can bring you closer. This guide gives you simple tools you can start using today, in your marriage, your family or your friendships.

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How to use this guide

- Go slowly. One page a day is enough.
- Use a pen. Writing helps you think and remember.
- Be honest and kind with yourself. There are no wrong answers.
- Follow the 7-day plan at the end, or go at your own pace.

Where are you today?

Circle a number for each sentence. 1 = not true for me, 5 = very true for me.

I feel heard by the people closest to me.	1	2	3	4	5
We can disagree without hurting each other.	1	2	3	4	5
I can say what I need clearly.	1	2	3	4	5
I trust the people closest to me.	1	2	3	4	5
We spend good time together.	1	2	3	4	5
I know how to make up after a fight.	1	2	3	4	5

Keep your answers. In a few weeks, try again and notice what has changed.

Four steps to begin

1

Slow down the conversation

Most fights get worse when we speed up. Slowing down gives everyone time to think and to feel safe.

YOUR TURN

Next time you feel tense, pause and breathe for 10 seconds. Then say: “Let me make sure I understand you.” Write what happened.

2

Listen to understand

Listening is not waiting for your turn to talk. It means repeating back what you heard before you answer.

YOUR TURN

Practice this sentence this week, then write how the other person responded.

What I hear you saying is: _____

Did I get that right? Their answer: _____

3

Say what you need

Start with “I feel… I need…” instead of “You always…”. It helps the other person listen instead of defend.

YOUR TURN

Rewrite this sentence: “You never help me.”

I feel: _____

when: _____

I need: _____

4

Repair quickly and often

Healthy couples and families still argue. What matters is how they repair. A simple “I’m sorry, can we try again?” goes a long way.

YOUR TURN

Write two repair phrases that feel natural to you.

_____

_____

_____

_____

A moment with God

Read these verses in your Bible, slowly. Then write what stands out to you.

Ephesians 4:2–3 **1 Corinthians 13:4–7**

What would patience and kindness look like in your hardest relationship this week?

Your 7-day plan

One small action a day. Check each box when you're done.

- ☐ **Day 1** Read this guide and finish the self-check.
- ☐ **Day 2** Notice when conversations start to speed up.
- ☐ **Day 3** Try the 10-second pause once.
- ☐ **Day 4** Practice repeating back what you heard.
- ☐ **Day 5** Use one "I feel… I need…" sentence.
- ☐ **Day 6** Plan 20 minutes of good time together.
- ☐ **Day 7** Ask: "What is one thing that would help you feel closer to me?"

Your next step

Closer

This guide is a beginning. In a free 15-minute call, you can talk with Dr. Emilia Arnaud about your path and see if one-on-one sessions are right for you. Online or in person, in English or Portuguese.

Or call or send a WhatsApp message:
(954) 899-3979 · wa.me/19548993979

Scan to book your free call

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